“I am under a generational curse.”

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Where it often comes from

Seeing the same problems repeat in your family, such as addiction, divorce, anger, or depression. Teaching that the sins of parents automatically bring a curse on children. Being told that you must break curses through special prayers or rituals. Feeling doomed to become like a parent. Fear that your own children will inherit your struggles.

What Scripture teaches

Families do pass down patterns, habits, wounds, and sometimes genetic tendencies. But Scripture teaches that each person answers for his own sin, not his parents’. Christ redeemed us from the curse by becoming a curse for us. If you are in Christ, you are a new creation. Family patterns can be real and hard, but they are not a spiritual sentence you cannot escape. They can be understood, healed, and changed with God’s help.

> *“Christ redeemed us from the curse of the law by becoming a curse for us. For it is written: ‘Cursed is everyone who is hung on a tree.’”* **(Galatians 3:13)**.

Also see

> “The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him” **(Ezekiel 18:20)**.

> “Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!” **(2 Corinthians 5:17)**.

> “Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus” **(Romans 8:1)**.

> “When you were dead in your trespasses and in the uncircumcision of your sinful nature, God made you alive with Christ. He forgave us all our trespasses, having canceled the debt ascribed to us in the decrees that stood against us. He took it away, nailing it to the cross!” **(Colossians 2:13–14)**.

Common self-statements

- I’m doomed to repeat my parents’ mistakes.
- My family is cursed.
- There’s no escaping what runs in my family.
- My children are cursed because of me.
- I need a special prayer to break this.
- God is punishing me for what my ancestors did.

Common logical errors

- **Fortune telling:** Predicting that you will become exactly like your parents.
- **Overgeneralization:** Turning family patterns into a spiritual sentence on everyone.
- **Personalization:** Taking responsibility for sins that belong to others.

- **Confusing correlation with cause:** Assuming that because problems repeat, a curse must be the reason.
- **Discounting the positive:** Ignoring what Christ's death has already done for you.

Challenging questions

- Who does Ezekiel 18:20 say bears the guilt for a sin?
- What did Christ do with the curse, according to Galatians 3:13?
- If I am a new creation, can an old family sentence still define me?
- Could these patterns be learned habits rather than a curse?
- What patterns in my family have already changed, even a little?
- Do I need a ritual, or do I need to trust what Christ already did?
- What wise steps could I take to break unhealthy patterns?

Truth summary

> I am not under a generational curse. Christ redeemed me from the curse by becoming a curse for me. I answer to God for my own life, not my ancestors'. Family patterns may be real, but they are not my destiny. In Christ I am a new creation, and with God's help I can learn new ways to live.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Christ, Sacrifice of
- Salvation
- Parenting
- Sin, Consequences of
- Born Again

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Christ, Who He Is
- Parenting
- Belief/Salvation

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I am under a generational curse"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I am under a generational curse." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who bears the guilt for a sin, according to Ezekiel 18:20?
- ☐ What did Christ do with the curse?
- ☐ Can an old family sentence define a new creation?
- ☐ Could these be learned habits rather than a curse?
- ☐ What has already changed in my family?
- ☐ What wise step can I take to break this pattern?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Christ redeemed me from the curse.
- ☐ I am a new creation in Christ.
- ☐ I answer to God for my own life, not my ancestors'.
- ☐ Family patterns are not my destiny.
- ☐ With God's help I can learn new ways to live.
- ☐ There is no condemnation for me in Christ Jesus.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Galatians 3:13**
  "Christ redeemed us from the curse of the law by becoming a curse for us. For it is written: 'Cursed is everyone who is hung on a tree.'"
- [ ] **Ezekiel 18:20**
  "The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him."
- [ ] **2 Corinthians 5:17**
  "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!"
- [ ] **Romans 8:1**
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."
- [ ] **Colossians 2:13–14**
  "When you were dead in your trespasses and in the uncircumcision of your sinful nature, God made you alive with Christ. He forgave us all our trespasses, having canceled the debt ascribed to us in the decrees that stood against us. He took it away, nailing it to the cross!"

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **New-pattern log:** Each day, write one way I chose differently from an old family pattern.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, 2 Corinthians 5:17 becomes: "Therefore if **Sarah** is in Christ, **she** is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!"*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Born Again" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Draw a simple family tree** and mark one unhealthy pattern. Then write one specific way you will handle it differently this week.
- ☐ **Do the opposite of the family pattern once,** such as speaking calmly instead of yelling, or asking for help instead of hiding.
- ☐ **Read Ezekiel 18 slowly,** and underline every statement about personal responsibility.
- ☐ **Talk with a counselor or wise Christian** about the patterns in your family and how to change them.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I am under a generational curse": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One new choice I made
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I am under a generational curse.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that Jesus redeemed me from the curse by becoming a curse for me. Help me reject the lie that I am under a generational curse. Show me the patterns I need to change, give me courage to choose differently, and remind me that in Christ I am a new creation. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.